Emotional Intelligence in Practice - Quick reference

Practitioner course | Trainer: Maya Thompson

The key ideas

- Emotions in everyday decisions: Emotion is data, not noise

- Reading your emotional signals: Notice the body first

- Staying steady in a heated conversation: Slow your breathing and your pace

- Feedback without the sting: Be specific about the behaviour

- Working through conflict: Make both sides feel heard

- Influencing without authority: Understand what the other person cares about

- Putting it into practice: Choose one conversation you have been avoiding

- Your next steps: Pick one conversation to have this week

Words to know

Position: What someone says they want in a disagreement.

Interest: The reason behind a position, which often overlaps with what the other side wants.

Defensiveness: A protective reaction to perceived criticism that makes listening harder.

Influence: Moving a decision or action without relying on formal authority.

Outcomes

- Stay steady in a heated conversation

- Give feedback that lands without defensiveness

- Influence peers without positional power